SOPHIA MCGEE

Full Stack Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevDesigns | Startup Development & Application Engineering | 2026–Present

- Developing a reusable website template system with React, Next.js and TypeScript, using component-based architecture and configurable layouts to support tiered service packages.
- Engineering an Angular-based client website with modular components, responsive UI architecture and structured page routing to support service-specific pages and quotation workflows.
- Developing a cross-platform application concept for an art business using React Native, alongside a React-based pantry management application, applying reusable components and maintainable application architecture.
- Evaluating frontend development patterns, UI/UX approaches and application structures to improve code maintainability, consistency and development efficiency

Full Stack Engineer | Charles River Laboratories | 2023 – 2026

Official Title: Associate Software Developer

- Led the migration from **Drupal CMS (PHP-based monolithic architecture)** to a headless **Next.js (TypeScript)** frontend integrated via REST and GraphQL APIs, supporting thousands of SEO-optimized pages.
- **Maintained** and extended **Drupal** content models, structured **schemas**, and **API endpoints** prior to the headless transition, ensuring clean content delivery and **SEO** integrity.
- Developed and implemented an enterprise **React + Chakra UI component library** aligned with **CMS-driven** content architecture, reducing UI development effort by approximately 40%.
- Delivered 100% WCAG 2.1 AA–compliant user interfaces within a regulated enterprise environment.
- **Enhanced Core Web Vitals** through code splitting, lazy loading, structured caching strategies, and frontend performance optimization across large-scale applications.
- Integrated applications with **RESTful services** and **GraphQL APIs** using **Apollo Client,** enabling structured data fetching, state management, and scalable frontend architecture.
- Owned end-to-end development of a secure user management MVP using **React, Node.js**, and **Fastify**, implementing authentication and authorization best practices.
- Improved complex **SQL queries**, backend services, and data integrity workflows to strengthen system performance and reliability.
- **Contributed** to **CI/CD pipelines**, Docker-based containerization, and cloud deployment workflows (**AWS / Azure DevOps**), ensuring stable, **production-ready releases**.
- **Migrated build** tooling from **Webpack** to **Vite** and transitioned testing frameworks from **Jest** to **Vitest**, significantly reducing pipeline execution times and improving developer efficiency.

***U*I Fullstack Developer & Design Intern | The Walton Institute | 2022**

- **Created high-fidelity prototypes and interaction flows in Figma and Adobe XD, grounded in usability and accessibility principles.**
- **Translated design systems into production-grade Angular applications supporting live client environments.**
- **Built three scalable web applications with responsive layouts, structured state management, and modular UI architecture.**
- **Streamlined performance through lazy loading, refactoring, and structured asset management, increasing performance scores by 20%.**
- **Strengthened client-side validation and API data handling, reducing integration defects by 25%.**

EDUCATION

Higher Diploma in Computer Science (First Class Honours)
South East Technological University

Bachelor of Arts in Visual Communication in Design (2:1)
Waterford Institute of Technology

SUMMARY

Full Stack Engineer with 5+ years of JavaScript experience and 3+ years delivering scalable web platforms in production environments. Experienced in **React-based architecture**, **GraphQL** integrations, and performance optimisation across complex **user interfaces**.
Skilled in developing **reusable component libraries**, improving **Core Web Vitals**, and contributing across frontend and backend systems using **Node.js**. Committed to clean code, accessibility standards, and building reliable applications that support long-term product growth.

SKILLS

Frontend & UI Engineering: React, Next.js, Angular, Vue.js, Tailwind CSS, Chakra UI, Material UI, Bootstrap, Sass, CSS3, HTML5, Redux Toolkit, React Query, Responsive Design, Component Libraries, Design Systems
UI/UX & Design Collaboration: Figma, Adobe XD, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), Interaction Design, Wireframing, Prototyping, Design Handoff Collaboration
API & Server-Side Development: Node.js, Express, Fastify, GraphQL, RESTful Services, API Integration, Authentication & Authorization
Data & Persistence: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, MariaDB, Gremlin, Data Modeling, Query Optimization
Cloud & Delivery: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Azure DevOps, GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Build Optimization, Deployment Pipelines
Testing & Quality Engineering: Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright, Unit Testing, End-to-End Testing
Performance & Accessibility: Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse Optimization, WCAG 2.1 AA, SEO Best Practices
Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, SQL, Python, Java, PHP, Kotlin, Dart, Nest.js (framework)
Operating Systems: macOS, Windows

SOFT SKILLS

- Customer-Facing Communication & Relationship Building
- Empathy & User-Centred Thinking
- Interpersonal Skills & Collaboration
- Active Listening & Requirements Gathering
- Problem-Solving & Analytical Thinking
- Adaptability & Continuous Learning

CERTIFICATIONS

Red Hat OpenShift I: Containers & Kubernetes
Red Hat System Administration (RH124, RH134, RH254)
React Fundamentals (2026)
JavaScript Fundamentals v2.0 (2026)
Oracle SQL Certification (2025)

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

App Development · Blender & Game Design · Painting · Board Games & Escape Rooms · Bouldering · Cinema · Singing · LOTR & Fantasy · Swimming